AI Cloud Peer Monitor: Q2 2026

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Bottom line

Demand for GPU cloud capacity is still outrunning supply. Both public peers more than doubled revenue year over year while spending 2.5x to 10x quarterly revenue on capex. Investors are rewarding contracted demand (backlog, ARR, prepayments) and power secured, and watching how the build-out is financed.

Key themes for investor conversations

- **Backlog is the headline metric.** CoreWeave's ~$104B backlog excludes more than $25B in new commitments signed early in Q3. Expect investors to ask Lambda for comparable visibility into contracted revenue.
- **Profitability gap below EBITDA.** CoreWeave posts a 59% adjusted EBITDA margin but a 5% adjusted operating margin and a net loss of $626M, driven by depreciation and interest. Margin bridges will be a recurring question.
- **Power is the new constraint.** Both peers now report gigawatts contracted. Power secured is becoming a proxy for future revenue capacity.
- **Financing the build-out.** Nebius expects more than $9B in customer prepayments in 2026, a lower-cost way to fund capex than debt. Funding mix will matter in IPO positioning.

Implications for Lambda's investor materials

- **Lead with contracted demand** and power secured, in the same units peers use, so investors can compare directly.
- **Prepare a margin bridge** from adjusted EBITDA to operating income to get ahead of the depreciation question.
- **Track peer disclosures quarterly** in a standing comps sheet (attached workbook) to keep Q&A materials current.